SpeedUP

English Course

Past Continuous & Interrupted Actions

WHAT WERE YOU DOING?

Past Continuous & Interrupted Actions

Why do we need Past Continuous?

Imagine this situation:

- *"You arrive late to a party. Your friend asks: 'Where were you? What were you doing?'"*
- ✅ *"I was driving home when I got stuck in traffic."* ✅ *"My sister was calling me when I was trying to leave."* ✅ *"While I was getting ready, my car broke down!"*

Past Continuous & Interrupted Actions

When do we use it?

When do we use it?	Situation	Example
	Action in progress in the past	*She was sleeping at 10pm.*
	Interrupted action	*I was cooking when you called.*
	Two simultaneous past actions	*While he was studying, she was watching TV.*
	Setting the scene in a story	*It was raining. People were running...*

Time Connectors (Conectores de Tempo)

How do we connect actions in the past?

while (enquanto)	*While I was studying, my dog started barking.*
when (quando)	*When she arrived, we were having dinner.*
during (durante)	*He fell asleep during the movie.*
meanwhile (enquanto isso / nesse meio tempo)	*She was cooking. Meanwhile, he was setting the table.*

Past Continuous

Affirmative, Negative, & Interrogative Forms

Affirmative

I was working
I was working at 8pm.

Negative

I **wasn't** watching TV
— I was reading.

Interrogative

Was she working?
Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.

SAME MEANING — Different structure!

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With WHILE	With WHEN	Meanwhile
While I was reading, my phone rang.	*My phone rang when I was reading.*	*John was cooking dinner. Meanwhile, Mary was setting the table.*
While he was running, he fell.	*He fell when he was running.*	

Questions:

- What was the man doing?
- What were the two women doing?
- What happened suddenly?
- What do you think happened next?